

Scratch Coding Cards

WHAT'S IN THE KIT

- Scratch coding activity card decks — games, stories, music, and interactive environments



QUICK-START GUIDE

1. Open scratch.mit.edu (free, no login needed to create).
2. Give each student or pair a card deck theme.
3. Cards walk students step-by-step through each build.
4. Finished early? Flip the card for remix challenges.

FULL LESSONS IN THIS GUIDE

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PRO TIP: Cards work great as a self-serve station — students can progress without whole-class instruction.

Scratch Coding Cards

LESSON · GRADES K-2

Animate Your Name

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Students will sequence commands to animate a sprite
- Students will use motion and sound blocks purposefully
- Students will describe what a program will do before running it

MATERIALS

- Scratch coding cards (Animation deck)
- Devices with scratch.mit.edu
- Headphones if available

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Model one card start-to-finish on the projector, thinking aloud.
2. Students open Scratch and pick the letters of their name as sprites.
3. Following the cards, each letter gets a motion or sound behavior.
4. Prediction ritual: before every green flag, say what will happen.
5. Share: each student performs their animated name for a neighbor.
6. Early finishers add a background or a second effect per letter.

ACTIVITY

Animate Your Name — every letter dances, spins, or sings. Students practice the predict-run-fix rhythm that is the foundation of all debugging.

Scratch Coding Cards

LESSON · GRADES 3-5

Chase Game Studio

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Students will build a playable game using loops, conditionals, and coordinates
- Students will playtest a peer's project and give structured feedback
- Students will revise a program based on user feedback

MATERIALS

- Scratch coding cards (Chase Game deck)
- Devices with scratch.mit.edu
- 'Two stars and a wish' feedback slips

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Walk through the first two chase-game cards as a class.
2. Students build the base game: sprite moves with arrow keys, chaser follows, score variable counts catches.
3. Card-guided extensions: speed changes, sounds, levels.
4. Playtest rotation: everyone plays a neighbor's game for 3 minutes.
5. Feedback: two stars (what works) and a wish (one improvement) on slips.
6. Revision time: implement at least one 'wish' before final save.

ACTIVITY

Chase Game Studio — build, playtest, revise. The feedback loop turns a coding exercise into a design cycle, and 'implement one wish' makes revision non-optional.

Scratch Coding Cards

LESSON · GRADES 6-8

Interactive Story Jam

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Students will structure a branching narrative with broadcasts and conditionals
- Students will use variables to track story state
- Students will storyboard before coding and reflect on plan vs. product

MATERIALS

- Scratch coding cards (Story deck) as reference
- Devices with scratch.mit.edu
- Storyboard template (paper)

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Show one example of a choose-your-own-adventure Scratch story.
2. Students storyboard: at least 2 decision points and 3 endings on paper.
3. Teach the pattern: buttons broadcast choices; scenes receive and switch backdrops.
4. Add a variable that tracks a choice early and changes an ending later.
5. Build and test all paths — every ending must be reachable.
6. Story swap: partners play through every branch and verify the map matches.

ACTIVITY

Interactive Story Jam — a branching story where an early choice pays off in the ending. Storyboarding first, then implementing, mirrors how real narrative games are written.